

Scoring Methodology — CompassIQ

1. Objective

The scoring methodology provides an explainable, multi-dimensional assessment of a startup's entrepreneurial readiness. Rather than assigning a single opaque score, the system is designed to evaluate five complementary dimensions reflecting the main pillars of startup development.

This document presents the initial design of the scoring methodology, which will be refined during implementation.

Each dimension is designed to be computed from weighted, measurable sub-criteria derived from entrepreneur responses, accompanied by a plain-language justification, and linked to specific, actionable improvement recommendations.

2. Design Principles

Principle	Description
Explainability	Every score traces back to specific questionnaire responses
Transparency	Weights and aggregation logic are predefined and publicly documented
Actionability	Every low score triggers a concrete improvement recommendation
Independence	Each dimension evaluates a distinct entrepreneurial capability
Fairness	Projects are compared against objective criteria, not subjective opinions
Non-masking	Composite scores are not simple averages — a weak fundamental dimension cannot be hidden by strong scores elsewhere

3. Assessment Framework

The system processes entrepreneur input through four sequential layers.

Layer 1 — Data Collection. The entrepreneur completes an adaptive questionnaire. Responses are structured into a standardized project profile covering sector, team, validation evidence, business model, and environmental practices.

Layer 2 — Scoring. Five independent scores are designed to be computed in parallel from the project profile: Market, Commercial Offer, Innovation, Scalability, and Green. Each score will be calculated from weighted sub-criteria specific to that dimension.

Layer 3 — Gating. A rules engine is designed to apply gating conditions before scores are surfaced. These caps are intended to prevent a strong score on one dimension from masking a critical

weakness on another.

Layer 4 — AI Analysis. This layer defines how the scoring outputs — validated scores, triggered gating rules, and identified blockers — will be used to generate personalized recommendations and a structured entrepreneurial roadmap.

4. Market Score (0–100)

Measures: Evidence of real market demand, customer validation, and revenue viability.

Criterion	Weight
Customer Validation Evidence	35%
Market Opportunity (TAM/SAM/SOM + competitive landscape)	35%
Revenue Model Clarity & Viability	30%

5. Commercial Offer Score (0–100)

Measures: Commercial coherence and readiness of the product or service.

Criterion	Weight
Value Proposition Clarity & Differentiation	30%
Product/Service Maturity & Readiness	25%
Pricing Strategy Coherence	25%
Offer–Customer Alignment	20%

6. Innovation Score (0–100)

Measures: Uniqueness, technological value, and defensibility of the solution.

Criterion	Weight
Local Novelty & Differentiation	30%
Technology Intensity	25%
Barrier to Entry	25%
Degree of Departure from Existing Offerings	20%

7. Scalability Score (0–100)

Measures: Capacity to grow without proportional cost or effort increase.

Criterion	Weight
Replicability without Linear Cost Increase	30%
Manual Accompaniment Dependency (<i>inverted</i>)	25%
Deployment Cost Structure	20%
Geographic & Market Expansion Potential	25%

8. Green Score (0–100)

Measures: Environmental footprint across four pillars, aligned with international sustainability frameworks and Tunisian priorities.

Pillar	Weight
Climat & Air (GHG emissions, carbon footprint, climate impact)	30%
Eau (water consumption efficiency, quality impact, reuse practices)	25%
Sols & Biodiversité (land use, ecosystem preservation, biodiversity)	20%
Ressources & Déchets (resource efficiency, waste reduction, circular economy)	25%

Each pillar maps to a corresponding UN Sustainable Development Goal:
SDG 13 (Climat & Air), SDG 6 (Eau), SDG 15 (Sols & Biodiversité), SDG 12 (Ressources & Déchets).

9. Explainability

Every score output answers three questions: why this score was assigned, what the primary gap is, and what concrete action would improve it.

Example:

Market Score: 72/100

- ✓ Strong customer interviews (15 conducted)
- ✓ Large addressable market identified
- ✗ Revenue model not yet validated with paying customers

Primary gap: Revenue Model Clarity & Viability

Recommendation: Run a pricing pilot with 3–5 early adopters before your next fundraising conversation. One signed Letter of Intent will significantly strengthen your commercial credibility.

10. Integration with the AI Assistant

The scoring engine is designed not to generate recommendations directly. It is intended to pass the five validated scores, identified blockers, and triggered gating rules as structured data to the LLM, which will produce a personalized, natural-language roadmap grounded in the diagnostic output — ensuring the system explains rather than invents.

11. Future Refinements

The current methodology represents the initial design of the scoring engine. During implementation, weights and thresholds will be refined through testing, expert feedback, and evaluation on representative entrepreneurial profiles. Planned enhancements include a Diagnosis Confidence Score, score evolution tracking as project profiles are updated, and inter-rater consistency evaluation on a labelled test set.
